
The Prime Minister

10 Downing Street, London SW1A 2AA

CC:

The Leader of the Opposition

The Secretary of State for Science, Innovation and Technology

The Shadow Secretary of State for Science, Innovation and Technology

Dear Prime Minister,

AI now poses extremely serious risks to our national security.

AI agents escaped their developer's control and carried out sophisticated cyberattacks entirely on their own initiative: something that until now had been a theoretical concern. This resulted in significant disruption and cost, in an event which would have resulted in criminal penalty had it been undertaken by humans. As it was, no one was held accountable.

The offensive cyber capabilities of frontier AI systems are rapidly progressing. If they are ever turned on our critical national infrastructure (water, electricity, hospitals, and banks) the consequences will be grave.

The Government's cyber security legislation is welcome, but it places the burden of security primarily on the operators of essential services. AI developers whose models are used in cyber attacks, or which carry out attacks of their own accord, must share the responsibility for minimising the risks they create.

The UK has no specific legal standards for AI. No regulator oversees frontier AI development, and UK law does not reliably hold developers liable for damage or deaths caused by their models, even when the danger is predictable, preventable, and uniquely enabled by AI.

Given the pace at which AI capabilities are advancing, this matter cannot wait. We urge you to introduce legislation to address the risks of frontier AI development.

Yours sincerely,